Glycemic Index Food Guide

Glycemic index (GI) ranks carb foods by how quickly they raise blood glucose. Lower GI choices often produce a gentler rise — but portion size (glycemic load) still matters.

Low GI ≤55

- Steel-cut / rolled oats
- Barley, bulgur, quinoa
- Most beans & lentils
- Non-starchy vegetables
- Apple, berries, orange
- Greek yogurt, milk
- Nuts, peanuts
- 100% stone-ground bread*

Medium GI 56–69

- Brown rice
- Couscous
- Whole-wheat bread*
- Quick oats
- Sweet potato
- Banana (ripe)
- Pineapple
- Popcorn

High GI ≥70

- White bread, bagels
- White rice, rice cakes
- Instant potatoes
- Cornflakes / puffed cereals
- Pretzels, crackers
- Watermelon
- Sugary drinks
- Many baked desserts

Practical ways to lower the rise

- Pair carbs with protein, fat, or fiber
- Choose intact grains over refined
- Prefer whole fruit over juice
- Cook pasta al dente; cool & reheat rice/pasta when helpful
- Watch portions even on low-GI foods
- Vinegar or lemon with meals may blunt spikes for some
- Walk 10–15 minutes after eating
- Compare your CGM/meter — personal responses vary

GI is a tool, not a rulebook

Ripeness, cooking method, processing, and what else is on the plate change GI. Total carbs and your medication plan remain the foundation. *Bread GI varies widely by brand and grain structure.

Educational reference only — not medical advice. GI values are approximate published averages and can vary by source and preparation.